



Boredom Diary

A 3–5 Day Cultural Probe

Your name:	
Study ID:	
Start date:	

Keep this booklet with you. Fill in an entry every time you notice you feel bored.

How to Use This Diary

1

Carry it with you

Keep this booklet in your bag or pocket during the study period (3–5 days).

2

Capture the moment

The moment you notice you feel bored, open to today's page and fill in the next empty entry. Try to do it in real time — not from memory later.

3

Be honest

There are no right or wrong answers. Your genuine experience is exactly what we need.

4

Up to 3 entries per day

There are 3 entry slots per day. If you feel bored more than 3 times, use the notes area at the back to add extra entries.

5

Missed a day?

No worries — tick the 'didn't feel bored' box or describe briefly what happened.

6

Return the booklet

Hand it back to the researcher at the end of the study period. Thank you!

What each question means

Time & Duration:	When the boredom started and roughly how long it lasted.
How bored?:	Rate intensity from 1 (barely bored) to 5 (intensely bored).
Where?:	The physical space you're in at that moment.
Who with?:	Your social situation — are you with others or alone?
Trigger:	The activity or situation that seemed to bring on the boredom.

Response:

What you instinctively did (or felt like doing) in reaction.

Thoughts/feelings:

Anything else on your mind — emotions, wishes, observations.

Day 1 · Monday

Fill in each entry the moment you feel bored.

Date: _____

Entry 1

Time: _____ : _____ ☐ AM ☐ PM

Duration: _____

How bored are you right now?

1 Not bored	2	3	4	5 Very bored
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Where are you?

☐ Home

☐ Class/Lecture

☐ Library

☐ Outdoors

☐ Transit

☐ Other _____

Who are you with?

☐ Alone

☐ Friends

☐ Classmates

☐ Family

☐ Strangers

☐ Mixed

What were you doing when boredom hit?

☐ Attending class

☐ Studying

☐ On my phone

☐ Waiting

☐ Commuting

☐ Other

What do you think triggered it?

What did you do in response?

☐ Picked up phone

☐ Doodled

☐ Day-dreamed

☐ Talked to someone

☐ Left

☐ Nothing

Any thoughts or feelings worth noting?

Entry 2

Time: _____ : _____ ☐ AM ☐ PM Duration: _____

How bored are you right now?

1 Not bored	2	3	4	5 Very bored
-------------	---	---	---	--------------

Where are you?

☐ Home ☐ Class/Lecture ☐ Library ☐ Outdoors ☐ Transit ☐ Other _____

Who are you with?

☐ Alone ☐ Friends ☐ Classmates ☐ Family ☐ Strangers ☐ Mixed

What were you doing when boredom hit?

☐ Attending class ☐ Studying ☐ On my phone ☐ Waiting ☐ Commuting ☐ Other

What do you think triggered it?

What did you do in response?

☐ Picked up phone ☐ Doodled ☐ Day-dreamed ☐ Talked to someone ☐ Left ☐ Nothing

Any thoughts or feelings worth noting?

Entry 3

Time: _____ : _____ ☐ AM ☐ PM Duration: _____

How bored are you right now?

1 Not bored	2	3	4	5 Very bored
-------------	---	---	---	--------------

Where are you?

☐ Home

☐ Class/Lecture

☐ Library

☐ Outdoors

☐ Transit

☐ Other _____

Who are you with?

☐ Alone

☐ Friends

☐ Classmates

☐ Family

☐ Strangers

☐ Mixed

What were you doing when boredom hit?

☐ Attending class

☐ Studying

☐ On my phone

☐ Waiting

☐ Commuting

☐ Other

What do you think triggered it?

What did you do in response?

☐ Picked up phone

☐ Doodled

☐ Day-dreamed

☐ Talked to someone

☐ Left

☐ Nothing

Any thoughts or feelings worth noting?

☐ I didn't feel bored today | ☐ I felt bored but couldn't record it — describe why:

Day 2 · Tuesday

Fill in each entry the moment you feel bored.

Date: _____

Entry 1

Time: _____ : _____ ☐ AM ☐ PM Duration: _____

How bored are you right now?

1 Not bored	2	3	4	5 Very bored
-------------	---	---	---	--------------

Where are you?

☐ Home ☐ Class/Lecture ☐ Library ☐ Outdoors ☐ Transit ☐ Other _____

Who are you with?

☐ Alone ☐ Friends ☐ Classmates ☐ Family ☐ Strangers ☐ Mixed

What were you doing when boredom hit?

☐ Attending class ☐ Studying ☐ On my phone ☐ Waiting ☐ Commuting ☐ Other

What do you think triggered it?

What did you do in response?

☐ Picked up phone ☐ Doodled ☐ Day-dreamed ☐ Talked to someone ☐ Left ☐ Nothing

Any thoughts or feelings worth noting?

Entry 2

Time: _____ : _____ ☐ AM ☐ PM Duration: _____

How bored are you right now?

1 Not bored	2	3	4	5 Very bored
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Where are you?

☐ Home ☐ Class/Lecture ☐ Library ☐ Outdoors ☐ Transit ☐ Other _____

Who are you with?

☐ Alone ☐ Friends ☐ Classmates ☐ Family ☐ Strangers ☐ Mixed

What were you doing when boredom hit?

☐ Attending class ☐ Studying ☐ On my phone ☐ Waiting ☐ Commuting ☐ Other

What do you think triggered it?

What did you do in response?

☐ Picked up phone ☐ Doodled ☐ Day-dreamed ☐ Talked to someone ☐ Left ☐ Nothing

Any thoughts or feelings worth noting?

Entry 3

Time: _____ : _____ ☐ AM ☐ PM Duration: _____

How bored are you right now?

1 Not bored	2	3	4	5 Very bored
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Where are you?

☐ Home

☐ Class/Lecture

☐ Library

☐ Outdoors

☐ Transit

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☐ Alone

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☐ Classmates

☐ Family

☐ Strangers

☐ Mixed

What were you doing when boredom hit?

☐ Attending class

☐ Studying

☐ On my phone

☐ Waiting

☐ Commuting

☐ Other

What do you think triggered it?

What did you do in response?

☐ Picked up phone

☐ Doodled

☐ Day-dreamed

☐ Talked to someone

☐ Left

☐ Nothing

Any thoughts or feelings worth noting?

☐ I didn't feel bored today | ☐ I felt bored but couldn't record it — describe why:

Day 3 · Wednesday

Fill in each entry the moment you feel bored.

Date: _____

Entry 1

Time: _____ : _____ ☐ AM ☐ PM

Duration: _____

How bored are you right now?

1 Not bored	2	3	4	5 Very bored
-------------	---	---	---	--------------

Where are you?

☐ Home ☐ Class/Lecture ☐ Library ☐ Outdoors ☐ Transit ☐ Other _____

Who are you with?

☐ Alone ☐ Friends ☐ Classmates ☐ Family ☐ Strangers ☐ Mixed

What were you doing when boredom hit?

☐ Attending class ☐ Studying ☐ On my phone ☐ Waiting ☐ Commuting ☐ Other

What do you think triggered it?

What did you do in response?

☐ Picked up phone ☐ Doodled ☐ Day-dreamed ☐ Talked to someone ☐ Left ☐ Nothing

Any thoughts or feelings worth noting?

Entry 2

Time: _____ : _____ ☐ AM ☐ PM Duration: _____

How bored are you right now?

1 Not bored	2	3	4	5 Very bored
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Where are you?

☐ Home ☐ Class/Lecture ☐ Library ☐ Outdoors ☐ Transit ☐ Other _____

Who are you with?

☐ Alone ☐ Friends ☐ Classmates ☐ Family ☐ Strangers ☐ Mixed

What were you doing when boredom hit?

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What do you think triggered it?

What did you do in response?

☐ Picked up phone ☐ Doodled ☐ Day-dreamed ☐ Talked to someone ☐ Left ☐ Nothing

Any thoughts or feelings worth noting?

Entry 3

Time: _____ : _____ ☐ AM ☐ PM Duration: _____

How bored are you right now?

1 Not bored	2	3	4	5 Very bored
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Where are you?

☐ Home

☐ Class/Lecture

☐ Library

☐ Outdoors

☐ Transit

☐ Other _____

Who are you with?

☐ Alone

☐ Friends

☐ Classmates

☐ Family

☐ Strangers

☐ Mixed

What were you doing when boredom hit?

☐ Attending class

☐ Studying

☐ On my phone

☐ Waiting

☐ Commuting

☐ Other

What do you think triggered it?

What did you do in response?

☐ Picked up phone

☐ Doodled

☐ Day-dreamed

☐ Talked to someone

☐ Left

☐ Nothing

Any thoughts or feelings worth noting?

☐ I didn't feel bored today | ☐ I felt bored but couldn't record it — describe why:

Entry 2

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Where are you?

☐ Home ☐ Class/Lecture ☐ Library ☐ Outdoors ☐ Transit ☐ Other _____

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What were you doing when boredom hit?

☐ Attending class ☐ Studying ☐ On my phone ☐ Waiting ☐ Commuting ☐ Other

What do you think triggered it?

What did you do in response?

☐ Picked up phone ☐ Doodled ☐ Day-dreamed ☐ Talked to someone ☐ Left ☐ Nothing

Any thoughts or feelings worth noting?

Entry 3

Time: _____ : _____ ☐ AM ☐ PM Duration: _____

How bored are you right now?

1 Not bored	2	3	4	5 Very bored
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Where are you?

☐ Home

☐ Class/Lecture

☐ Library

☐ Outdoors

☐ Transit

☐ Other _____

Who are you with?

☐ Alone

☐ Friends

☐ Classmates

☐ Family

☐ Strangers

☐ Mixed

What were you doing when boredom hit?

☐ Attending class

☐ Studying

☐ On my phone

☐ Waiting

☐ Commuting

☐ Other

What do you think triggered it?

What did you do in response?

☐ Picked up phone

☐ Doodled

☐ Day-dreamed

☐ Talked to someone

☐ Left

☐ Nothing

Any thoughts or feelings worth noting?

☐ I didn't feel bored today | ☐ I felt bored but couldn't record it — describe why:

Day 5 · Friday

Fill in each entry the moment you feel bored.

Date: _____

Entry 1

Time: _____ : _____ ☐ AM ☐ PM

Duration: _____

How bored are you right now?

1 Not bored	2	3	4	5 Very bored
-------------	---	---	---	--------------

Where are you?

☐ Home

☐ Class/Lecture

☐ Library

☐ Outdoors

☐ Transit

☐ Other _____

Who are you with?

☐ Alone

☐ Friends

☐ Classmates

☐ Family

☐ Strangers

☐ Mixed

What were you doing when boredom hit?

☐ Attending class

☐ Studying

☐ On my phone

☐ Waiting

☐ Commuting

☐ Other

What do you think triggered it?

What did you do in response?

☐ Picked up phone

☐ Doodled

☐ Day-dreamed

☐ Talked to someone

☐ Left

☐ Nothing

Any thoughts or feelings worth noting?

Entry 2

Time: _____ : _____ ☐ AM ☐ PM Duration: _____

How bored are you right now?

1 Not bored	2	3	4	5 Very bored
-------------	---	---	---	--------------

Where are you?

☐ Home

☐ Class/Lecture

☐ Library

☐ Outdoors

☐ Transit

☐ Other _____

Who are you with?

☐ Alone

☐ Friends

☐ Classmates

☐ Family

☐ Strangers

☐ Mixed

What were you doing when boredom hit?

☐ Attending class

☐ Studying

☐ On my phone

☐ Waiting

☐ Commuting

☐ Other

What do you think triggered it?

What did you do in response?

☐ Picked up phone

☐ Doodled

☐ Day-dreamed

☐ Talked to someone

☐ Left

☐ Nothing

Any thoughts or feelings worth noting?

Entry 3

Time: _____ : _____ ☐ AM ☐ PM Duration: _____

How bored are you right now?

1 Not bored	2	3	4	5 Very bored
-------------	---	---	---	--------------

Where are you?

☐ Home

☐ Class/Lecture

☐ Library

☐ Outdoors

☐ Transit

☐ Other _____

Who are you with?

☐ Alone

☐ Friends

☐ Classmates

☐ Family

☐ Strangers

☐ Mixed

What were you doing when boredom hit?

☐ Attending class

☐ Studying

☐ On my phone

☐ Waiting

☐ Commuting

☐ Other

What do you think triggered it?

What did you do in response?

☐ Picked up phone

☐ Doodled

☐ Day-dreamed

☐ Talked to someone

☐ Left

☐ Nothing

Any thoughts or feelings worth noting?

☐ I didn't feel bored today | ☐ I felt bored but couldn't record it — describe why:

End-of-Study Reflection

Complete this after your last diary day.

Which situation made you feel most bored during the study?

Did anything surprise you about when or how often you felt bored?

What did you usually do to cope with boredom — and did it help?

Is there a pattern in where or when your boredom tends to happen?

Anything else you'd like to share with the researcher?

Extra Entries

Use this space if you had more than 3 boredom episodes in a day.

Entry Extra 1

Time: _____ : _____ ☐ AM ☐ PM Duration: _____

How bored are you right now?

1 Not bored	2	3	4	5 Very bored
-------------	---	---	---	--------------

Where are you?

☐ Home ☐ Class/Lecture ☐ Library ☐ Outdoors ☐ Transit ☐ Other _____

Who are you with?

☐ Alone ☐ Friends ☐ Classmates ☐ Family ☐ Strangers ☐ Mixed

What were you doing when boredom hit?

☐ Attending class ☐ Studying ☐ On my phone ☐ Waiting ☐ Commuting ☐ Other

What do you think triggered it?

What did you do in response?

☐ Picked up phone ☐ Doodled ☐ Day-dreamed ☐ Talked to someone ☐ Left ☐ Nothing

Any thoughts or feelings worth noting?

Entry Extra 2

Time: _____ : _____ ☐ AM ☐ PM Duration: _____

How bored are you right now?

1 Not bored	2	3	4	5 Very bored
-------------	---	---	---	--------------

Where are you?

☐ Home ☐ Class/Lecture ☐ Library ☐ Outdoors ☐ Transit ☐ Other _____

Who are you with?

☐ Alone ☐ Friends ☐ Classmates ☐ Family ☐ Strangers ☐ Mixed

What were you doing when boredom hit?

☐ Attending class ☐ Studying ☐ On my phone ☐ Waiting ☐ Commuting ☐ Other

What do you think triggered it?

What did you do in response?

☐ Picked up phone ☐ Doodled ☐ Day-dreamed ☐ Talked to someone ☐ Left ☐ Nothing

Any thoughts or feelings worth noting?

Entry Extra 3

Time: _____ : _____ ☐ AM ☐ PM Duration: _____

How bored are you right now?

1 Not bored	2	3	4	5 Very bored
-------------	---	---	---	--------------

Where are you?

☐ Home ☐ Class/Lecture ☐ Library ☐ Outdoors ☐ Transit ☐ Other _____

Who are you with?

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What were you doing when boredom hit?

☐ Attending class ☐ Studying ☐ On my phone ☐ Waiting ☐ Commuting ☐ Other

What do you think triggered it?

What did you do in response?

☐ Picked up phone ☐ Doodled ☐ Day-dreamed ☐ Talked to someone ☐ Left ☐ Nothing

Any thoughts or feelings worth noting?
